



HYDERABAD BLAST

May 18, 2007

TOLL: 12 dead, 50 injured

WHERE: Mecca Masjid near Charminar.

WHO DID IT: Suspected Huji militants used an IED which was triggered by cell phones. The bomb exploded when people had gathered for the Friday prayers.

GROUND ZERO: Mecca Masjid near Charminar smeared with blood

DELHI

April 2006

TOLL: 14 injured

WHERE: Twin blasts inside the Jama Masjid.



WHO DID IT: Unidentified militants used crude bombs with mechanical timers.

STATUS: Unsolved

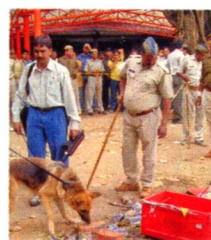
VARANASI

March 2006

TOLL: 21 dead, 62 injured

WHERE: At the Sankat Mochan temple

WHO DID IT: Huji militants carried out the attack using IEDs by putting them in pressure cookers.



STATUS: Six Huji militants arrested.

PAST Terrorism has become a pan-Indian phenomenon

MALEGAON

Sept 2006

TOLL: 40 dead, 312 injured

WHERE: Three blasts including one in a mosque.



WHO DID IT: Suspected LeT and SIMI terrorists planted IEDs on bicycles.

STATUS: Unsolved.

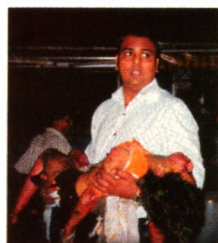
DELHI

October 2005

TOLL: 62 dead, 155 injured

WHERE: At three places in Delhi.

WHO DID IT: Unidentified terrorists



planted IEDs in three crowded places which went off one by one within 30 minutes.

STATUS: Unsolved.

MUMBAI

July 2006

TOLL: 209 dead, 714 injured

WHERE: In six local trains.

WHO DID IT: LeT and SIMI activists



planted IEDs which they kept in pressure cookers in the trains' first-class compartments.

STATUS: Unsolved.

AYODHYA

July 2005

TOLL: None

WHERE: At the disputed Babri Masjid site.



WHO DID IT: Unidentified terrorists used AK rifles and grenades to attack the site.

STATUS: Attackers killed.

fice. It now has at least six sleeper cells in the city and Shahed has close ties with the Jaish-e-Mohammed (Jem) and Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT). The nature of the improvised explosive and its remote trigger mechanisms—mobile phones rigged to explosives—bear Huji hallmarks. Operating from Bangladesh and recently sighted in Karachi, Shahed is also believed to have masterminded the smuggling of RDX into Hyderabad last year.

Responding to an INDIA TODAY questionnaire early last year, Home Minister Shivraj Patil had mentioned the spread of terrorism through the hinterland as one of his greatest concerns. A year later, terrorism has become a pan-Indian phenomenon. Patil's fear has become a reality and yet, the Centre does not seem to have a plan to deter it. This lack of response and a regular intelligence sharing mechanism between the states fails to pre-empt attacks or even solve them. This gives transnational terror kingpins an upper hand. They strike and scoot, leaving the police to nab those involved in the periphery. "Most states see terrorism as a law and order problem," says an intelligence official. This explains why practically no significant arrests have been made in the terror attacks in the past two years.

The Hyderabad police, for instance, were unaware of the importance of LeT operative Sheikh Sameer alias Sheikh Nayeem arrested by the BSF on the Bangladesh border. Sameer claimed to have smuggled around 20 sleeper agents into India, disclosed his involvement in the Mumbai bombings and hinted at activating sleeper cells in a few places including Hyderabad. The police did not pursue these leads.

Security agencies, including the Intelligence Bureau, tipped the police on the possibility of serious attempts to disturb communal harmony in the city. But these alerts were treated with criminal casualness by the policemen who defused a second unexploded IED with no protective gear and before a large crowd of potential victims. If the Mecca Masjid bombing indicates the ease with which the Islamic terror networks can strike, the lack of a coordinated thrust against them can only embolden them to strike again. ■